the cultivators could store the harvested produce and take advantage of advances until prices stabilized. Long before Regional Rural Banks were thought of, Sorabji had explored the implications of district joint-stock banks on which he prepared a report for the Board of Directors.

In keeping with his policy of transparency and openness in banking operations, the lack of which had caused grief to many institutions and the public in the past, Sorabji started issuing fortnightly statements in order to convince customers that the bank's affairs were in order. This regular disclosure of assets and liabilities was followed by other banks as well and soon became an integral feature of the banking scene. From 1921, the bank also started the instructive and valuable practice, of giving under separate heads, the aggregate interest paid on fixed deposits and current deposits.[9]

Sorabji's innovations were many and varied, (in fact in nearly everything he did, he was treading new ground), but it was his concern for his staff that marked him as a manager with a difference. Sorabji was always imbued with a sense of mission, a mission which included not just the success of his own institution, but the banking system as a whole. He said: 'The Central Bank is not merely a profit-making shop but an organization that has a mission to fulfill—part of which is to train a corps of official bankers in the interest of the country's economic development.'[10]

Sorabji's system of training was in contrast with the old-fashioned paternalism of the early twentieth century. What he sought and achieved was as close an identification as possible between management and staff. He realized that it was essential to have staff who were not simply doing a job but who also believed and shared in the values, ideas, and ethos of the organization. To this end, seminars were held, a library opened, and a monthly magazine (*Centralite*) was published. It was also the first bank to arrange for foreign training of young Indian bankers. From 1923, the Central Bank organized regular training courses for the staff. Such training usually took place after banking hours from 8 to 9 pm and all the staff members were encouraged to join in. Books were provided for free and the staff was encouraged to appear for the examination of the Institute of Bankers in London. Seminars on a variety of subjects on banking and finance under the guidance of experts were held every month. The Central Bank also provided training to young bankers from other countries with the first group being from the State Bank of Ceylon, an institution which was